

Matchday XI — Official Rulebook (v2.1, Investor/MVP Build)

1. Overview

Matchday XI is a football lineup-prediction platform. Users pick a favorite Premier League club, guess the starting XI before it's officially confirmed, and are scored automatically the moment the real lineup drops. Free to play at the core; monetization layered on top (see Section 12, currently roadmap-only).

2. Accounts & Team Selection

One favorite team per user, selected from all 20 current Premier League clubs.

Squad lists are pulled live from the sports data API, not hardcoded, so they stay current through transfer windows.

Team selection is locked once a user submits their first lineup prediction. Before that first submission, the user may freely change their selected team. After it, the team is permanent for that account — no switching, to keep leaderboard history and team identity unambiguous.

3. Competitions Covered

Premier League (all 38 matchweeks)

FA Cup — Premier League clubs' fixtures only

EFL Cup (Carabao Cup) — Premier League clubs' fixtures only

4. Lineup Format

Every prediction (and the official lineup it's scored against) is exactly 11 players: **1 Goalkeeper + 10 outfield players.**

Only players tagged Goalkeeper may fill the GK slot.

The 10 outfield slots are freely assigned — users may place any combination of defenders, midfielders, and forwards into any of the 10 outfield positions, unconstrained by their tagged position.

Default displayed formation is **1-4-4-2**, purely as a visual starting layout; it does not restrict selection.

5. Deadlines & Locking

Locking is automatic: **2 hours before actual kickoff**, driven by live fixture data.

No manual locking, no edits permitted after lock under any circumstance.

6. Official Lineup Feed (Automated)

Fixture schedules and kickoff times are pulled from **football-data.org** (free tier: fixtures, results, standings).

Official lineups are pulled from **API-Football** (free tier: includes lineup data).

Lineup-check job runs on a bounded retry window starting ~75 minutes before kickoff, checking every ~10 minutes until a lineup is found (typically resolves by T-60 to T-70), rather than continuous polling — this keeps usage well within both providers' free-tier request caps.

Scoring is triggered automatically the moment the official lineup is detected.

The lineup used for scoring is the final confirmed XI at kickoff; a late pre-kickoff change supersedes an earlier announcement.

7. Scoring

+1 point per predicted player who appears in the official starting XI, regardless of slot/position.

+3 bonus points for an exact full-XI match (all 11 correct).

No points for substitutes or unused players.

No captain/multiplier mechanic (evaluated and explicitly removed from scope).

8. Leaderboards

Global leaderboard — all users, ranked by cumulative season points.

Per-team leaderboards — users ranked only against other fans who selected the same favorite team (e.g. Arsenal fans vs. Arsenal fans).

Both leaderboards publicly display each user's **number of Perfect XI predictions**, alongside total points.

Per-user history view of past matchday predictions and results.

9. Prizes (Free Tier)

Monthly prize: no longer top-scorer-based. Instead, a **random draw** among users who, in that calendar month, (a) submitted a prediction for every matchday their team played, **and** (b) logged into the app every day of that month.

Daily login streak is tracked per user to support the above (and future engagement features).

End-of-season prizes: grand prize for #1 on the season-long global leaderboard, plus separate 2nd and 3rd place prizes.

Tiebreaker (for ranking/prize purposes): (1) number of Perfect XIs, then (2) earliest account creation date.

10. Edge Cases

Postponed/abandoned matches: matchday voided, no points awarded either way.

Duplicate accounts: disqualifies the user from prize eligibility (points may still accrue but prizes are forfeited).

One account per person, enforced at the fair-play level.

11. Platform

Built and launched as a **web app (installable PWA)** — full-screen, home-screen-installable on iOS and Android via browser "Add to Home Screen," no app store submission required at MVP stage.

Native app store submission (iOS/Android) is a deliberate later-phase decision — deferred pending real user traction and, if the paid features are involved, regulatory clearance (see Section 12).

12. Paid Features — ROADMAP ONLY, NOT LIVE IN THIS BUILD

Everything in this section is to be built as **disabled / "Coming Soon"** in the current MVP. No real payment processing, entry collection, or payout logic goes live until Nigerian gaming-law licensing (or an alternative compliant structure) is confirmed with qualified legal counsel.

12a. Tiered Global Prize Pools

Paid entry tiers (illustrative, not final): ₦1,000 / ₦10,000 / ₦100,000, each with its own separate pool and leaderboard.

Payout model: hybrid guaranteed-minimum + scaling pool — a committed minimum prize, topped up by accumulated entries once a funding threshold is crossed; typically 70-85% of entries to the prize pool, remainder to platform costs/margin (exact split TBD).

Eligibility to win (regardless of point ranking): must have submitted a prediction for every matchday their team played that season, **and** achieved a minimum of 10 Perfect XIs over the season.

12b. Private Competitions ("Private Leagues")

Creation: limited to subscribed users; each subscriber may create **exactly one** private league.

Joining: subscribers only (not free-tier users). A user requests to join; the creator approves or denies. Once approved, the user gains access immediately if the league is free, or after payment if it's paid.

Discovery: private leagues are searchable by name; joining still requires creator approval regardless of how the league was found.

Team rules: the creator sets, at creation, one of: (a) members may pick any team from any league, (b) members may pick only from one specified league, or (c) all members must use the same single team.

Time window: creator sets a custom active period (e.g. one month, or a specific run of matchdays) — does not have to match the full season.

Rules are immutable once the league is created, and must be visible to all members at all times.

Scoring is entirely separate: private-league predictions are a distinct submission from the user's global/team-leaderboard prediction. Private league points/results do **not** feed into the global or per-team leaderboards, and vice versa.

Membership cap: none. Creation cap: one private league per subscriber.

Monetization (paid leagues only, roadmap): creator sets an entry fee (or makes the league free). Revenue split on paid entries: **15% platform, 15% creator, 70% prize pool**. The full split is disclosed to the creator at

creation time; members see only the resulting prize pool amount, not the platform/creator cuts. The free version of this feature (no entry fee) is **not** subject to the same regulatory blocker and may be considered for earlier build — flag this explicitly when scoping build phases with Claude Code.

13. Version History

v1.0 — Initial 3-team demo rulebook (Arsenal, Man City, Liverpool). Captain/multiplier mechanic built, then removed.

v2.0 — Full MVP scope: all 20 Premier League clubs + FA Cup/Carabao Cup fixtures, 1-GK+10-outfield free-form format, automated 2-hour lock, automated live lineup feed (football-data.org + API-Football), per-team leaderboards with public Perfect XI counts, redefined monthly prize + login streak tracking, tiered global prize pools (roadmap), private competitions (roadmap for paid tier, free tier buildable now). Web app/PWA first; native app store submission deferred.

v2.1 — Clarified team selection: locked permanently once a user submits their first prediction; free to change before that.